

# Guide: Using Your Own Excel Tables in the Matrix Tool

---

You are reading this document because you have decided to use your own idea list or custom evaluation combinations in the Matrix Tool at [gruppe4-projektentwicklung.de](https://matrix.gruppe4-projektentwicklung.de). This guide explains step by step how to fill out, expand, or adjust the necessary Excel tables—so that your upload runs smoothly and your data is correctly displayed and evaluated.

---

## 1. Where can I find the templates?

The starting point is always <https://matrix.gruppe4-projektentwicklung.de/select-data>. Here you can download the current templates for the **ideas table** ("idea") and the **combinations table** ("kombi").

There are several ways you can use the tool with your own content:

**a) You fill out both tables (ideas and combinations):** This way, you not only define your own ideas, but also specify exactly how these are evaluated and compared in the tool.

**b) You only fill out the ideas table:** In this case, the tool automatically uses the standard combinations for evaluation. This means you do not need to create your own combinations table. However, it is important that your ideas table contains all attributes (i.e., fields) required for the evaluation combinations. If you use the provided template, this is already ensured.

**c) You only fill out the combinations table:** You can also focus solely on evaluation combinations. In this case, you continue working with the existing ideas table and its attributes—so you only adjust how the existing ideas are evaluated and combined.

---

## 2. Using your own ideas: Step by step

Once you have downloaded the ideas table template, open it in Excel. The table is structured so that you can easily see what to enter where:

- **In the first row** are the so-called column IDs (e.g., `#-#1`, `#-#2`, etc.), which the tool uses to recognize which attribute is which. IDs must always follow this pattern so that everything is recognized correctly.
- **In the second row** are the names of the attributes. These are for your reference only and can be freely changed. They have no technical function, but make the table easier to read for you and others.

You can adapt the list of attributes as you wish: **You can add your own attributes by simply continuing the numbering** (for example, `#-#3`, `#-#4`, etc.) and always creating the corresponding unit column (`##+3`, `##+4`, etc.) next to each attribute. **Likewise, you can remove attributes you do**

**not need.** If you remove attributes, please make sure that each remaining attribute still has its corresponding unit column and that the numbering remains consistent. **Important:** If you remove attributes that are used in evaluation combinations, you will need to deactivate any combination in the tool (in the step where you weight or select combinations) that references a removed attribute. Only then will you avoid error messages during evaluation, as the tool would otherwise try to access values that no longer exist.

The current template allows for up to **200 different attributes**.

#### **Each attribute must always have a matching unit column!**

Be sure to follow the pattern at all times: for example, `#-#5` for the value, next to it `#+#5` for the unit, then `#-#6` / `#+#6`, and so on.

#### **Multilingual support (optional)**

If you want to use the table in multiple languages, simply fill in title and description in the relevant language columns. For each language there are separate columns, with IDs such as: `#t_en#1` (English title), `#t_de#1` (German title), and so on. You can enter your values directly in the corresponding columns.

When displaying results, the tool automatically detects the currently selected language on the website and shows the appropriate values. If you only want to use your table in one language, it is sufficient to fill in just the relevant column.

---

### **3. Uploading and validating your table**

Save your completed file and upload it on the "select data" page using the upload button. The system checks in the background whether your table meets the requirements—especially whether all IDs are correct and all necessary unit columns are present. If everything is in order, your file will appear in the dropdown menu and can be selected for evaluation.

If you receive an error message, please check:

- Are all column IDs written correctly (no spaces, no typos)?
- Is there a unit column for each attribute?
- Are all required fields present and filled in?

---

### **4. Using your own combinations**

If you want to create your own evaluation combinations, download the combinations template and open it in Excel. The combinations table works a little differently than the ideas table:

- **You must not add or remove columns here.**
- **You may only add or remove rows—that is, create new combinations or edit/delete existing ones.**

In the combinations table, each row represents a single evaluation combination. You always use the IDs of the attributes from your ideas table and enter them in the formula column (e.g., `#-#4/#-#8`). The tool can access all attributes from your ideas table as long as you follow the ID pattern.

Each combination also requires the following fields:

- **Formula:** Enter the actual calculation here, for example `#-#4/#-#8` (for CO<sub>2</sub> emissions per lifetime).
- **Formula Text:** Here you should enter a clear, understandable description of the formula, which will later be displayed in the tool. For example: "CO<sub>2</sub> emissions relative to product lifetime".
- **High/Low:** Use this field to define whether a **higher value** is considered "better" or a **lower value** is better. For example, for "CO<sub>2</sub> emissions per lifetime," a lower value is of course better—here you enter "low". If a higher value is better (e.g., "energy efficiency"), enter "high".

Please ensure that the IDs in the formulas match the existing attributes in your ideas table exactly.

**Tip:** You can add as many combinations (rows) as you wish, or remove existing ones, but you must not add or remove columns here.

---

## 5. Summary

With this guide, you can create, adapt, and upload your own tables for the Matrix Tool. Always follow the specified syntax and the instructions for IDs and units. Adjust attributes and combinations flexibly to your needs. Always check before uploading that everything is filled out correctly. If you have questions or uncertainties, consult the template or contact support.

**Good luck with your custom evaluation matrix!**